SUNMI JUNG

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Labor Economics, Urban Economics, Metascience

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Economics, University of Pittsburgh	2022–present
M.A., Economics, Sogang University	2021
B.A., Public Administration (dual major: Economics), Kookmin University	2018

PUBLICATIONS

"Dating Apps and Marriage Rates" (with Lester Lusher). *Economics Letters, 2026*

Abstract: We estimate how the diffusion of the dating app Tinder affected marriage outcomes in the United States. Using Google search intensity for "Tinder" as a proxy for platform exposure and individual-level data from the Current Population Survey, we estimate event-study specifications for adults aged 21–35. We find no effect on overall marriage rates or the timing of first marriage. However, Tinder exposure is associated with higher divorce or separation rates, particularly at younger ages. Marriage effects emerge in male-heavy and thin dating markets, suggesting that dating apps primarily ease matching frictions rather than increasing aggregate marriage formation.

"Empirical Analysis on the Effect of Korean Manufacturing Agglomeration on Location Decisions of Services FDI Firms" (with Jung Hur). *Journal of Korean Economic Studies, 2021*

Abstract: This paper analyzes the effect of manufacturing agglomeration on service firms' FDI location decisions by dividing it into the extensive margin (number of affiliates) and the intensive margin (the amount of investment) using the firm-level data from 2009 to 2018. As a result, we find that foreign direct investments by service firms significantly rise with the agglomeration of manufacturing firms. This empirical result suggests that Korean service firms are establishing a global production-service network.

WORKING PAPERS

"P-hacking for Popularity? Media Attention and Statistical Significance in Economics Working Papers" (with Brianna Funderburk and Lester Lusher)

Abstract: If media outlets cover "sensational" research, and if studies producing these results have greater p-hacking, then one would find positive correlations between marginal statistical significance and media attention. We code 7,022 estimates from a random sample of 404 NBER working papers and precisely estimate little difference in the distribution of test statistics by media attention. Our estimates differ significantly from forecasts made by 215 economists, most of whom predicted positive correlations. We further find abstract views and downloads are uncorrelated with statistical significance. In exploratory analyses, we document patterns in statistical significance and ChatGPT-generated measures of interest, influence, and convincingness.

Conference Presentations

CMU–Pitt Labor Economics Student Workshop 2026

Teaching Experience

Instructor, Intro Microeconomic Theory Summer 2025
Teaching Assistant, Intro Microeconomic Theory Spring 2024, Fall 2025
Grader, Intermediate Microeconomic Theory Fall 2026
Grader, Game Theory Fall 2024, Spring 2025
Grader, Intro to Development Economics Fall 2023
Grader, Intro to International Economics Fall 2023
Grader, Economic Data Analysis Spring 2023

Research Experience

Graduate Research Assistant to Claire Duquennois Spring 2026
Graduate Research Assistant to Omer Ali Summer 2025

Referee Service

Economic Inquiry, *Journal of Social and Personal Relationships*

Skills

Software: Stata, R, Python
Languages: Korean, English